
**DEPARTMENT
POLICY****FIP Only**

Each eligible child under age six must receive all immunizations recommended by the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services (MDHHS). The group is in compliance when immunizations have **begun** for all children subject to this requirement.

The group's payment standard is reduced by \$25 for each month in which the following apply:

- One or more eligible children under age six are **not** immunized, **and**
- The group has no unresolved barriers to immunizations.

Consider a child to be age six for the full month in which he/she reaches age six.

Child Development and Care (CDC) Only

Each non-exempt, eligible child for whom CDC is requested must receive all immunizations recommended by the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services (MDHHS), as verified by self-certification. The child is in compliance when immunizations have **begun**.

Note: A licensed child care provider may require documentation related to immunizations, and may allow less time to comply with immunization requirements than the CDC program. These licensing requirements do not impact a child's eligibility for the CDC benefit. Clients (parents) should discuss these requirements with their licensed provider.

EXEMPTIONS**FIP and CDC**

A child is exempt from the immunization requirement if:

- He/she is under two months of age.
- Immunizations are medically inappropriate for the child.
- Immunizations are contrary to the family's religious beliefs.

GRACE PERIOD**CDC Only**

A child who has not met the immunization requirement will have a grace period that extends until the next eligibility determination. If the child fails to meet the immunization requirement at the next eligibility determination, the child will not be eligible to receive the CDC benefit.

**IMMUNIZATION
PENALTY****FIP Only**

At redetermination, Bridges reduces the group's payment standard by \$25 for each month in which:

- One or more non-exempt eligible children under age six are **not** immunized, **and**
- The group has no unresolved barriers to immunization.

The penalty is **not** initiated at case opening.

Related FAP

The unreduced FIP payment standard is budgeted in related FAP cases when an immunization penalty is imposed on the FIP group.

CDC Only

At redetermination, CDC eligibility will end for a child who does not meet the immunization requirement and did not meet the immunization requirement at or since the previous eligibility determination, according to the grantee's self-certification.

At reapplication/member add, CDC will be denied for a child who does not meet the immunization requirement and did not meet the immunization requirement at or since the most recent application or redetermination eligibility period, according to the grantee's self-certification.

A denial will only impact the child who has not met the requirement.

Compliance

FIP Only

The group is in compliance when immunizations have **begun** for all non-exempt children. When the group begins immunizations, enter the date the group begins as the *Circumstances Start Change Date* and *Cooperation Begin Date* on the *Immunizations* screen. Do **not**:

- Wait until immunizations are complete, **or**
- Require written verification.

The group is in compliance for the whole month in which immunizations are begun. Bridges will remove the penalty and issue a supplement to affect the full month of compliance when the regular monthly issuance cannot be affected.

CDC Only

The child is in compliance when immunizations have **begun**. If the child begins immunizations after being out of compliance, enter the date the child begins as the *Circumstance Start Change Date* on the *Immunization* screen. Do **not** do either of the following:

- Wait until immunizations are complete.
- Require written verification.

Bridges will allow CDC eligibility to be approved for the child.

Assisting Clients

FIP Only

Assist clients to resolve problems which hinder compliance with the immunization requirement prior to imposing the penalty. This might include:

- Assistance with transportation; see BAM 825, **and**
- Referral to the group's health provider or to the local health department.

Document these efforts in the physical case record or in *Case Comments* on Bridges.

**APPLICATION
PROCEDURES****FIP Only**

At application, do the following:

- Inform the FIP group with a non-exempt child under the age of six of the following:
 - Immunization requirement.
 - Penalty for failure to immunize, which might be initiated at redetermination.
- Review the information titled Immunize Your Children (FIP only) from the Cash Assistance section of the MDHHS-1171-INFO, Information Booklet, with the client to ensure full understanding of this requirement.
- Refer the group to its health provider or to the local Health Department for more information on immunizations, as needed.

CDC Only

At application, do the following:

- Inform the CDC client with a non-exempt child for whom CDC has been requested of the following:
 - Immunization requirement.
 - Penalty for failure to immunize, which might be initiated at redetermination.
- Refer the group to its health provider or to the local Health Department for more information on immunizations, as needed.

Reapplication**FIP Only**

At reapplication, ask if a formerly penalized group is now willing to comply. The penalty continues at reopening if the:

- FIP EDG closed while being penalized, or because the penalty was initiated, **and**

- Group is unwilling to comply at reopening, **and**
- Group has no unresolved barriers to immunization.

CDC Only

At reapplication, CDC will be denied for a child who does not meet the immunization requirement and did not meet the immunization requirement at the most recent eligibility determination, according to the grantee's self-certification.

A denial will only impact the child who has not met the requirement.

REDETERMINATION PROCEDURES

FIP Only

At redetermination, ask the client if there are any children under age six who are not up-to-date on their immunizations (shots) in the FIP EDG. If any non-exempt eligible child is not up-to-date on immunizations, the group might be subject to the penalty.

Ask why the child has **not** been immunized. If a problem such as lack of transportation hinders compliance, do all of the following:

- Assist the client to resolve the problem through appropriate referrals or other actions.
- Document all actions in the physical case record or in *Case Comments* in Bridges.
- Follow up with the group at the next annual redetermination.

Do **not** enter a non-cooperation date on the *Immunizations - Details* screen in Bridges if a group has an unresolved problem that hinders compliance. If the client is uncertain whether immunizations are up to date for a child under six, treat that as a problem which hinders compliance. Refer the group to its health provider or to the local health department and document your actions in the physical case record or in *Case Comments* in Bridges.

If the group is not cooperating, use the date the group became non-compliant as the *Circumstances Start/Change Date* and the *Non-Cooperation Date* on the Bridges *Immunization - Details* screen.

Bridges will give the group timely notice of this action and affect the next possible month. If imposing the penalty results in a grant amount under \$10, the FIP EDG will close.

CDC Only

At redetermination, eligibility will end for a child who does not meet the immunization requirement and did not meet the immunization requirement within the previous grace period, according to the grantee's self-certification.

A denial will only impact the child who has not met the requirement.

VERIFICATION REQUIREMENTS

FIP and CDC

Accept the client's statement, or declaration on an application, redetermination or change document that one of the following applies:

- All children in the FIP group, or children(ren) for whom CDC has been requested, have met the immunization requirement.
- Immunizations are contrary to the family's religious beliefs.
- Immunizations are medically inappropriate for a child.

Use the client's response on the current or most recent application, redetermination, change document, or the client's verbal statement. Do **not** require written verification. Document verbal statements and resulting eligibility decisions in the case record or in *Case Comments* in Bridges.

Document all actions taken to assist the group with compliance prior to imposing the penalty in the case record or Case Comments in Bridges.

LEGAL BASE

FIP

42 USC 608(b)(2)(A)(ii)
MCL 400.57g
Mich Admin Code, R 400.3115

FAP

7 USC 2017(d)

CDC

The Child Care and Development Block Grant (CCDBG) Act (42 USC § 9858 et seq.), as amended by the CCDBG Act of 2014 (Pub. L. 113-186).

45 CFR Parts 98 and 99.

Social Security Act, as amended 2016.